

November

13

Let it snow

The first artificial snow was produced in Massachusetts, USA, after a plane dropped ice crystals into a natural cloud. Unfortunately, the snow evaporated before it could hit the ski slopes below.

1946

Born this day

1715 Dorothea Christiane Erxleben, German doctor. She was the first woman to be licensed to practise medicine.

1955 Whoopi Goldberg, Black American actor. She has won an Emmy, a Grammy, an Oscar, and a Tony award.

1856

Big Ben bongs

The gigantic bell now known as Big Ben struck its first notes in a test exercise. Made for the new tower beside the Palace of Westminster in London, UK, its booming chimes attracted quite a crowd.

Statue in a sewer

A bust dating from 300 BCE of the ancient Greek god Hermes was found in a sewer in Athens, Greece. The sculpture was in good condition, despite its murky surroundings.

2020



Also on this day

1956 Segregation on buses in Alabama, USA, was declared illegal by the US Supreme Court, ending the Montgomery bus boycott.

1985 A volcanic eruption in Colombia destroyed the town of Armero, killing 25,000 people – the deadliest lahar (mud flow) ever.

2010 Burmese politician Aung San Suu Kyi was released after seven years of house arrest.

